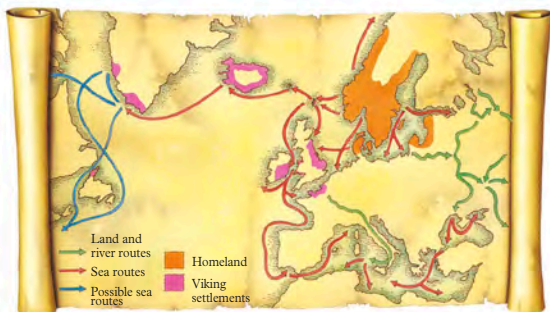
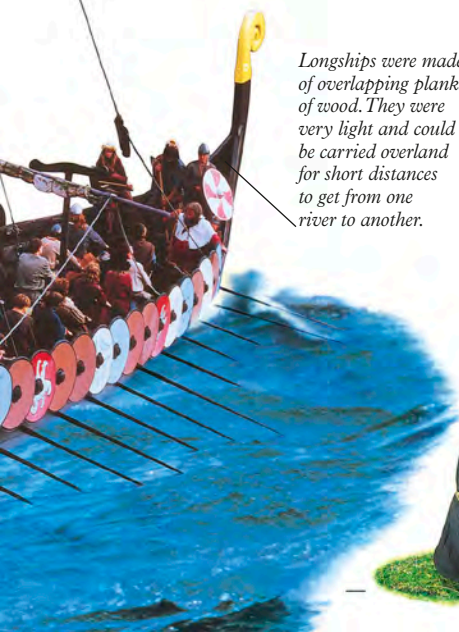




Where the Vikings went

The Vikings roamed great distances. Merchants sailed across the rivers of Russia and around the Mediterranean Sea. They traded such northern objects as furs and walrus tusks for southern objects such as silk and silver. Explorers sailed to Iceland, Greenland, and to Newfoundland in North America. They called this Vinland.

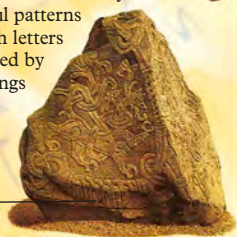
Longships were made of overlapping planks of wood. They were very light and could be carried overland for short distances to get from one river to another.



Strange stones

The Vikings set up stones, called runestones. They were carved with many beautiful patterns and with letters developed by the Vikings called runes.

Runes



Fascinating tales

Storytelling was very popular. These stories, or sagas, were long poems describing brave deeds, journeys to strange lands, and victories in battle. Before the Vikings learned to write, they remembered stories by learning them by heart.

